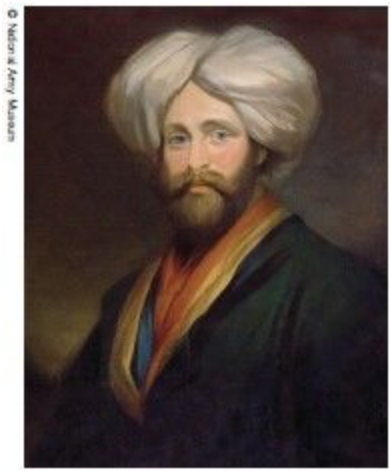
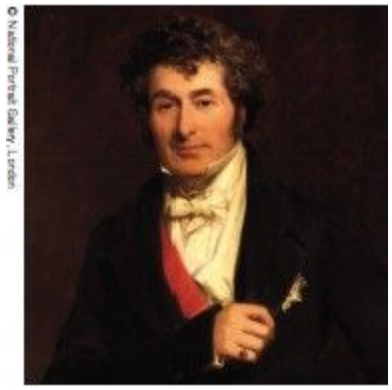


Major Eldred Pottinger, nephew of Wade's great rival Sir Henry Pottinger, was in Herat disguised as a Muslim horse trader when the Qajar Persian army attacked it.



MacNeill, the Russophobe British ambassador in Teheran whose cable, 'The Russians have formally opened their diplomatic intercourse with Kabul' convinced the British that Dost Mohammad needed to be replaced. 'Lord Auckland should now take a decided course,' he advised, 'and declare that he who is not with us is against us ... We must secure Afghanistan.'



Edward Law, 1st Earl of Ellenborough, was the first to turn anxiety about Russia into public policy. 'Our policy in Asia must follow one course only,' he wrote in his diary, 'to limit the power of Russia.'